

Dhayanand Baskar

Building high-throughput distributed systems that stay fast, reliable, and correct while serving millions of users.

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01 PROFILE

Software engineer with 12+ years of experience designing and scaling distributed, high-throughput systems across HR technology, logistics, mobility, and SaaS. Combines deep system-design fundamentals with hands-on delivery—from domain modeling and API design to data partitioning, asynchronous workflows, production reliability, and performance optimization. Translates complex domains into resilient platforms and measurable business outcomes.

01 THOUGHTWORKS / GRAB

3B+

rides completed across Southeast Asia at Jan 2019 platform scale; built real-time driver order assignment and lifecycle systems

02 PERSONIO

2M+

employee balances handled by the reporting materialization platform I led

03 FORTO

Real-time tracking

built shipment event-ingestion pipelines that stayed correct when third-party updates arrived late, duplicated, or out of order

02 SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Personio

Jun 2022 — Present

Senior Backend Engineer · Berlin

- Led backend architecture and implementation for absence management, powering balance, policy, holiday, payroll, calendar, and reporting workflows across Personio's multi-tenant HR platform.
- Reduced Absence Balance API latency by ~70% at P95 and ~60% at P99 through query optimization, batching, workload isolation, and database-level tuning—eliminating timeout failures for a high-impact customer.
- Led the design and delivery of a balance materialization system covering 2M+ employee balances, replacing expensive real-time aggregation with precomputed, reporting-ready data that was faster, more predictable, and easier to reconcile.
- Strengthened event-driven data pipelines with idempotent consumers, retry-safe synchronization, reconciliation, observability, and reliable downstream payroll and calendar integrations.
- Drove technical initiatives from design through rollout: aligning cross-functional stakeholders, reviewing architecture, mentoring engineers, defining operational runbooks, and supporting production incidents.

Forto

Sep 2019 — May 2022

Backend Software Engineer · Berlin

- Built core backend services for transportation management, real-time shipment visibility, and external logistics partner booking.
- Designed event-ingestion flows that normalized third-party tracking updates and remained correct when events arrived late, duplicated, or out of order.
- Modeled multi-step partner bookings as long-running, event-driven state machines with explicit transitions, retry policies, reconciliation, and failure recovery.
- Used domain-driven design and event storming with logistics leaders to create a scalable Transport Plan model and incrementally automate operational workflows.

03 CORE EXPERTISE

ARCHITECTURE

Distributed Systems
Event-Driven Architecture
Microservices · SOA
Domain-Driven Design
State Machines · REST APIs

LANGUAGES

Java · Kotlin
TypeScript · JavaScript
Node.js · Spring Boot

DATA & PLATFORM

PostgreSQL · MySQL
Oracle · MongoDB
AWS · Kubernetes
Messaging · C/CD

SCALE PATTERNS

Sharding · Partitioning
Caching · Materialization
Idempotency · Retries
Eventual Consistency
Schema Evolution

ENGINEERING

Performance Tuning
Reliability · Observability
Automated Testing
Incident Response
Technical Leadership
Mentoring · Design Reviews

04 EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Thoughtworks / GrabDec 2017 — Sep 2019

Fullstack Software Engineer · Bengaluru

- Worked on Grab's driver team as the platform crossed 3B rides across Southeast Asia in January 2019; built Android and backend capabilities for real-time order delivery and the assignment lifecycle from offer through acceptance, rejection, and completion.
- Led the Driver Incentive initiative across product and engineering, translating complex incentive rules into driver-facing experiences and supporting microservices.
- Improved driver navigation flows and contributed to Google ride-hailing integration, coordinating changes across Android, backend APIs, and external systems.
- Worked in a high-volume marketplace where low-latency dispatch, fault tolerance, and service reliability directly affected drivers, customers, and marketplace liquidity.

WhatfixMay 2017 — Dec 2017

Fullstack Software Engineer · Bengaluru

- Developed an analytics platform for collecting, processing, and presenting engagement data from Whatfix's SaaS onboarding and interactive guidance products.
- Built full-stack capabilities spanning instrumentation, backend APIs, data aggregation, and user-facing reporting for product-usage insights.
- Partnered across teams to deliver scalable, algorithm-driven product features with maintainable interfaces and testable business logic.

MphasisJul 2014 — May 2017

Fullstack Software Engineer · Pune

- Developed a full-stack telecom ordering system for Sprint, contributing across order capture, validation, enterprise workflows, backend service orchestration, relational data access, and user-facing capabilities.
- Delivered features within a large enterprise codebase, collaborating with distributed teams and balancing new functionality with compatibility, testing, and production stability.

05 SYSTEMS THINKING

Designs for scale from first principles, balancing correctness, latency, operability, and cost.

- 01 Partition intelligently**
Geo-partition for residency and latency; hash-shard by stable, high-cardinality identifiers to distribute load.
- 02 Make events safe**
Use idempotency, deduplication, versioning, retries, and reconciliation for delayed or out-of-order delivery.
- 03 Design for operations**
Build in SLOs, metrics, traces, alerting, runbooks, failure isolation, and controlled degradation.
- 04 Evolve with evidence**
Profile before optimizing; use caching, precomputation, batching, indexes, and workload separation deliberately.
- 05 Route and rebalance**
Use shard metadata, virtual partitions, controlled data movement, and dual-read or dual-write migrations to scale without downtime.

06 EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology
Anna University · Chennai

2010 — 2014

07 ADVANCED STUDY

Algorithms
Princeton University

2018 — 2019

Advanced Distributed Systems Design
SOA & DDD · Particular Software

2020

08 HOW I LEAD

SET DIRECTION

Turn ambiguous domains into clear boundaries, design documents, API contracts, and phased technical roadmaps.

RAISE THE BAR

Use design reviews, pragmatic testing, code reviews, and mentoring to improve both systems and engineering judgment.

SHIP SAFELY

Prefer observable, reversible rollouts with migration plans, compatibility guarantees, measurable SLOs, and explicit ownership.